

DANIEL OLSHANSKY

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ABOUT ME

Curious, relentless, and multidisciplinary engineer with 3+ years of management and 12+ years of professional experience at the intersection of augmented reality cloud infrastructure, autonomous vehicle planner evals, distributed systems, crypto protocols, and creator content monetization. My mission is to expand human capability through software at the intersection of the physical world by leveraging AI. I do this by navigating tradeoffs, aligning human incentives, evaluating cognitive overload, biasing toward semi-automation, and thinking slowly while acting fast.

EXPERIENCE

CTO @ Grove

2025 - Present

- **Context:** A pivot to agentic stablecoin based micropayments to enable content creator monetization.
- **Built:** A wallet-first landing page for creators. We saw the shift to stablecoin infrastructure, new protocols like x402, and shifted our strategy to enable humans and agents alike.
- **Impact:** Onboard hundreds of creators and processed thousands of micropayments for content across more than a dozen social networks.

Head of Protocol @ Pocket Network (CTO @ Grove Labs)

2021 - 2025

- **Context:** Managed a team designing & building a decentralized protocol, live on dozens of exchanges, managing alignment across hundreds of stakeholders.
- **Built:** Designed & led the R&D for a permissionless API marketplace serving decentralized data access at scale using a verifiable rate limiter.
- **Impact:** Launched a \$100M+ protocol serving 1B+ daily requests; led and rebuilt the core protocol team through a CTO transition.

Geotechnical Founder @ GetSoils & BreakingGround

2021–2022, 2025–Present

- **GetSoils (2021–2022):** Scaled an “AirBnB for construction soil” to hundreds of users in Ontario; learned that traditional industry adoption requires meeting customers where they are.
- **BreakingGround (2025–Present):** Fine-tuning visual models via the Tinker API for geotechnical soil analysis; educating the industry on pragmatic AI adoption at calgeo.org.

Senior Software Engineer, Planner Eval @ Waymo (Alphabet)

2020 - 2022

- **Context:** The Planner Eval team was responsible for evaluating planner models across real, simulated, golden, and adversarial datasets at scale.
- **Built:** Test set corpus for reproducible evals, labeling infrastructure, and visualization tools for data scientists on the Planner Eval team and beyond.
- **Impact:** Drove the org-wide test-set initiative; 50+ data scientists across 6+ teams managing thousands of test sets for mission-critical evals costing millions of dollars.

Lead Software Engineer, Augmented Reality Cloud @ Magic Leap

2016 - 2020

- **Context:** Joined day 1 of the cloud team at Magic Leap to build device management and design the AR cloud.
- **Built:** AR cloud digital twin using raw sensor data for object recognition, sparse/dense mapping, and multiplayer localization.
- **Impact:** Shipped Magic Leap One device management and the Shared World SDK to thousands of users. Led 5 engineers and co-authored 15+ patents.

Software Engineer @ Twitter

2014 - 2016

- **Context:** First engineering role out of college at a top-tier consumer platform; grew from coder to engineer.
- **Built:** A variety of full stack features across data pipelines, mobile, web, and backend on both the VIT and Media teams.
- **Impact:** Shipped GIF search, custom timelines, and vetted account features to 10s of millions of daily users.

EDUCATION

Internships

2011 - 2013

ModiFace (mobile computer vision), Twitter (iOS), Google (Android)

University of Toronto

2010 - 2014

B.A.Sc in Engineering Science, Electrical & Computer Engineering • GPA: 3.84 • Dean's List • NΨ 1T4

Thesis: Accelerating PCA for fMRI analysis using GPUs and MapReduce

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES *(all items below are hyperlinked)*

Writing: Posts, Thoughts, Substack, Medium

Presenting: Talks & Interviews

Consuming: Books, Podcasts, Movies, TV

Publishing: Google Scholar

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Python · Go · Java · Scala · C/C++ · Elixir · iOS · Android · PostgreSQL · Kubernetes · GCP · MQTT · PubSub · MapReduce · Distributed Systems · Consensus Algorithms · API Design · Agentic Payments · Data Labeling · Test Sets · Tinker · x402 · Stablecoin · Agentic Infra & Tools · Skills